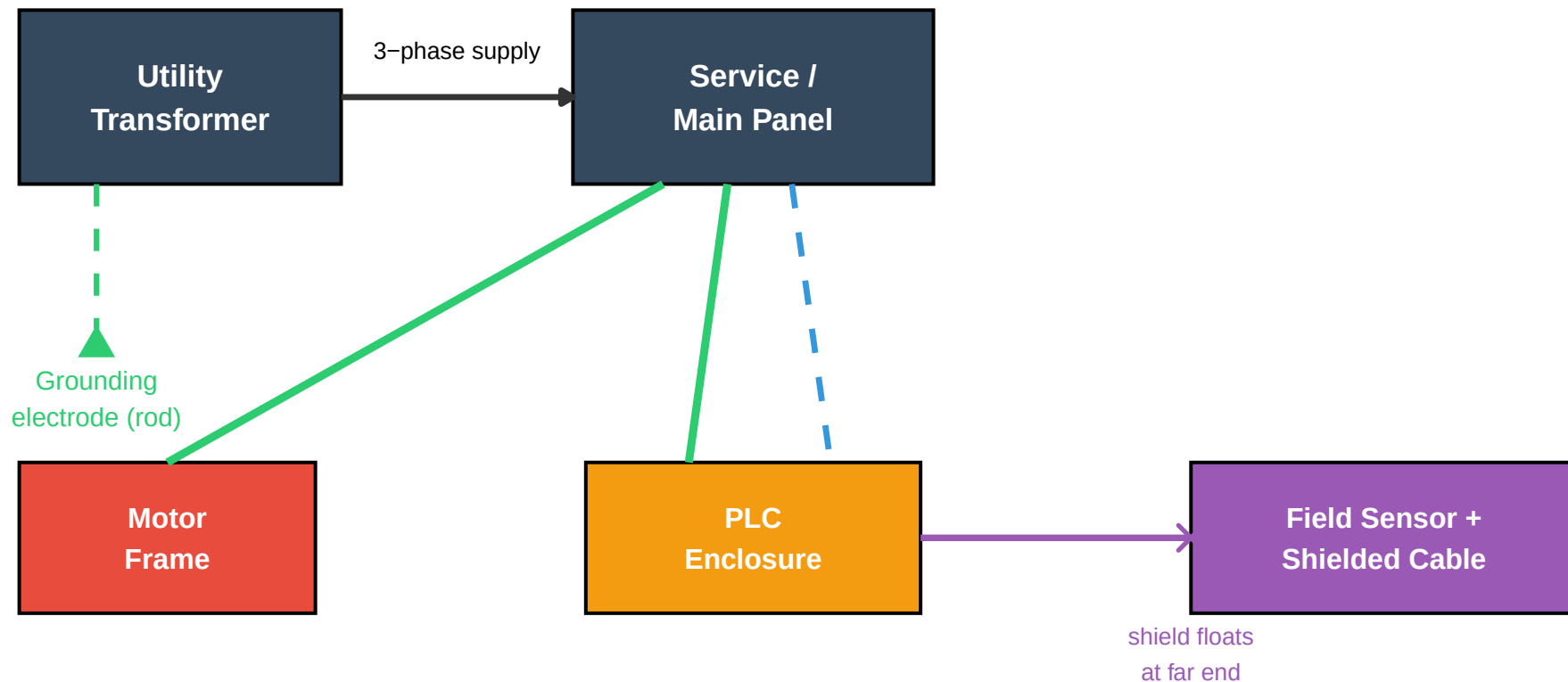


Four Conductive Paths, One Confusing Name

Equipment bonding, system grounding, functional/signal ground, and shield each serve a different purpose



- Equipment bonding -- low-impedance fault-current path (CEC Sec. 10 / NEC Art. 250)
- Functional / signal ground -- reference only, NOT a fault-current path
- Cable shield -- grounded at ONE end only (low-frequency instrumentation)
- ▲ System grounding electrode -- voltage reference / lightning-surge path to earth